Percentage of

$$\text{nitrogen} = \left(\frac{28}{22.4} \times \frac{V_0}{W}\right) \times 100$$

$$= \frac{28}{22.4} \times \frac{29.58 \times 10^{-3}}{0.1688} \times 100$$

$$= 21.90\%$$



Dumas method is a high precision method and is generally preferred over Kjeldahl's method.

Kjeldahls method:

This method is carried much more easily than the Dumas method. It is used largely in the analysis of foods and fertilizers. Kjeldahls method is based on the fact that when an organic compound containing nitrogen is heated with Conc. H_2SO_4, the nitrogen in it is quantitatively converted to ammonium sulphate. The resultant liquid is then treated with excess of alkali and then liberated ammonia gas absorbed in excess of standard acid. The amount of ammonia (and hence nitrogen) is determined by finding the amount of acid neutralized by back titration with same standard alkali.

Procedure:

A weighed quantity of the substance (0.3 to 0.5 g) is placed in a special long – necked Kjeldahl flask made of pyrex glass. About 25 mL of Conc. H_2SO_4 together with a little K_2SO_4 and $CuSO_4$ (catalyst) are added to it the flask is loosely stoppered by a glass bulb and heated gently in an inclined position. The heating is continued till the brown color of the liquid first produced, disappears leaving the contents clear as before. At this point all the nitrogen in the substance is converted to $(NH_4)_2SO_4$. The Kjeldahl flask is then cooled and its contents are diluted with distilled water and then carefully transferred into a 1 lit round bottom flask. An excess NaOH solution is poured down the side of the flask and it is fitted with a Kjeldahl trap and a water condenser. The lower end of the condenser dips in a measured volume of excess the $\frac{N}{20}$ H_2SO_4 solution. The liquid in the round bottom flask is then heated and the liberated ammonia is distilled into sulphuric acid. The Kjeldahl trap serves to retain any alkali splashed up on vigorous boiling. (See Fig. 11.3)

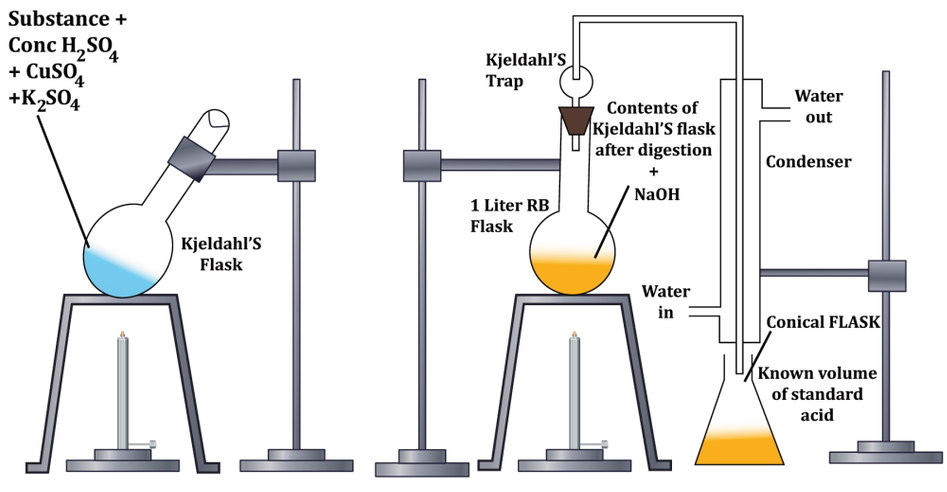


Fig 11.3 Kjeldahls method

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